Alisa Liao

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Education

University of California San Diego, Revelle College Expected June 2029
B.S. in Cognitive Science GPA: **3.958** *La Jolla, CA*
Coursework: Research Methods, Neurobiology of Cognition, Data Science in Practice, Cognitive Consequences of Technology, Design at Large

Mission San Jose High School June 2025
Valedictorian | 150+ Service Hours *Fremont, CA*

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, Java, HTML, CSS
Skills: Human Behavior Research, Data Analysis, Project Management, UI/UX
Tools: Adobe Photoshop, Figma, Qualtrics

Experience

Research Assistant Jan 2026 – Sep 2026
Emotions and Empathy Lab, UC San Diego *La Jolla, CA*
- Contribute to social psychology study on social interactions examining how emotion suppression and expression affect interpersonal closeness
- Facilitate experiments by guiding participants through protocols to ensure high-quality, unbiased data collection
- Assist in study design by collecting pilot data and providing input on experimental methodology
- Develop a comprehensive codebook standardizing survey variables to streamline data analysis and ensure consistency across datasets

Design For America IDEA Board Lead June 2026 – Present
Design For America, UC San Diego *La Jolla, CA*
- Improve program workflow, teaching designers of all skill levels how to facilitate UI design, user research, and client satisfaction
- Build community engagement and manage program, educating the next generation of designers at UCSD

Scientific Illustrator Oct 2025 – May 2026
Saltman Quarterly Research Journal, UC San Diego *La Jolla, CA*
- Increase accessibility of published research by creating complementary illustrations for a peer-reviewed science journal
- Collaborate with authors and editors to improve readability and transparency in scientific communication

Graphic Design Intern Sep 2025 – May 2026
Revelle Creatives, UC San Diego *La Jolla, CA*
- Completed design projects commissioned by Revelle College organizations, building client communication experience

Music and Art Branch Director & Volunteer Tutor Aug 2021 – Jul 2025
BOBtutor *Remote*
- Directed Music and Art Branch for nonprofit, promoting accessibility of arts education for children
- Led online fundraising events raising over $2,000 for Tshepang Care Center serving orphaned children in South Africa
- Implemented and managed a system of virtual music and art lessons, integrating both education and fundraising initiatives
- Taught singing and art to children aged 5–9

Projects

Brilliance Exposed Website Redesign | *Figma, User Research* Jan 2026 – July 2026
- Selected via Design For America to redesign website for Brilliance Exposed, a nonprofit photography exhibition
- Build high-fidelity Figma prototypes with team, improving aesthetics, user experience, and professional appearance
- Facilitate user research and interpret and apply the results to our research-based product

Fremont BoxART! Public Art | *Mural Design, Painting* May – Jul 2024
- Selected by City of Fremont to design and paint a public electrical box as part of a citywide beautification initiative
- Created visually compelling design promoting sustainability and upcycling for a community engagement program

Activities

Volunteer | *Brain Exercise Initiative* Oct 2025 – Present
- Facilitate math, reading, and writing exercises with elderly residents at retirement homes to support cognitive health

Volunteer | *TCV Food Bank* Jun – Sep 2025
- Collaborated with 6-person team to distribute food at a community center serving over 10,000 individuals monthly

Volunteer | *The Tech Interactive, San Jose* Dec 2023 – Jan 2024
- Engaged visitors of all ages with interactive STEAM exhibits, maintaining safety and educational standards

Private Tutor | *Math & English, Ages 5–8* Dec 2023 – Jan 2026
- Taught children according to demonstrated skill level, adapting curriculum to individual learning needs